

Workshop

When a single power supply just can't cut it, here's how you combine the power of two to satiate your PC

**Google Domains out**

Google finally launched its own domain hosting service with invite-only access <http://dg.it.in/GoogleDomainsBeta>

New laptop acting up, upgrading obsolete monoliths, finicky reboots and upgrade queries

All in a day's work for the Digit Test Centre

Q Brand new laptop woes

Well the laptop is Dell Inspiron 15R 5537 with Windows 8.1 preloaded. But just within a week or so I faced certain problems. Can you help me fix these? Are these normal? Do I need to be worried?

1. Took a lot (3min 45 sec) to boot yesterday. Worked fine after that.
2. The laptop occasionally hangs, stops responding, which is frustrating.
3. Certain Websites on IE (Metro version) do not show up until you click on 'fix connection'.
4. I haven't loaded any bloat-ware or data on it as yet. Just testing it.

Does it look serious? Should I be worried? Thanks. I'm anticipating your reply.

—Sam

A Hey Sam,

1. If it's the first time you booted your laptop (unbox and first use scenario), then the booting and Windows launch does take a bit of time. Upwards of 3 or 4 mins. But it works fine afterwards, as you noticed, and it's nothing to worry about. However, if this happens at every reboot or cold boot (complete shutdown and then start again), then something's not right.
2. Definitely not normal behaviour.
3. Which websites are these? This must be down to your problematic net connection, in all probability.
4. Good habit. :)

Point #1 and #2 are definitely serious, enough for you to start considering a replacement for your machine – since you bought it recently and it's brand new, within warranty, etc.

I think you should get your laptop fixed or replaced under Dell's warranty terms. Let me know how it goes.

Q EMI component upgrades

Hi Team Digit,

I think that my RAM needs to be upgraded. I need your team's help. I want an 8 GB RAM around ₹5000.

My computer's specifications:

- OS: Windows XP SP 2
- CPU: Intel Pentium E2200@2.2GHz
- Old RAM: 2 GB single channel DDR3 @ 399MHz(6-6-6-15)
- Motherboard: Biostar G41D3C
- GPU: NVIDIA GE FORCE 210
- HDD: 80 GB Internal HDD
- 1 TB external hard drive

I know this PC is obsolete but my mother said you can only upgrade one part per month only.

—Anany Prakhkar



If you see a puffed capacitor, watch out!

A Hey Anany,

You're indeed in a conundrum. You see the particular motherboard and CPU combo results in support for 800 MHz RAM only. This is because of the CPU of yours which has an FSB of 800 MHz can only support RAM of the same of lower FSB. Even if you do buy modules which are rated higher they'll be forced by the motherboard to run at 800 MHz. This too, is not a fool-proof

solution. In all likelihood it might not work at all. We've couldn't even find the modules in nearby online stores.

If your parents have asked you to upgrade one component at a time which is a wonderful idea in itself, then we'd suggest coming up with a configuration now and then slowly put your computer together as time goes by. This way you can purchase the motherboard this month, then the processor two months later (since they are comparatively expensive) and then the RAM the month after that. This way in about 8-10 months you can completely upgrade your computer.

Q First time PC builder

Hi, this is the first time I am building a PC, so I need your help.

Could you tell me whether the configuration is compatible and suggest me a PSU for the same

My configuration would be:

- Processor: Intel Core i3-4130 3.4 GHz
- Motherboard: Gigabyte GA-B85-D3H processor
- RAM: Kingston KHX1600C10D3B1/8G or Kingston KHX1600C9D3B1/4G
- DVD writer: LG GH24NS95 or
- Samsung SH -224DB
- HDD: Toshiba DT01ACA100
- Cabinet: Antec One S3

Is this configuration computable with each other and could you tell me a power supply unit for this! And a budget monitor also. Please check my configuration and help me in PSU and Monitor and The compatibility of the configuration. Hope you could help me soon as possible as I am planning to build in this week and waiting for your green signal.

Thanking you in advance

—Gandhar Gosavi